have to be infatuated on a sustained basis for many years for one party to gain control of the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha.

It is better to have power dispersed vertically between the Union government, state governments and local governments. In this, public choice theory takes us to the same argument as traditional wisdom of liberal democracy on the value of decentralization.

It is better for any one industry to be answerable to many masters ranging from income tax law to competition law to sectoral regulation. If an industry is excessively dominated by one regulatory agency, this generally yields poor outcomes owing to the concentration of power.

It is better for power to be dispersed between the ruling party and the opposition. The standing committees of Parliament are an example of establishing institutions that foster negotiation, and the dispersion of power. Bills are processed by standing committees, and in every case that we have been personally involved, we have seen that standing committees have improved bills. Standing committees, which are Shivraj Patil's contribution to the Indian institutional infrastructure, have become a forum for negotiation between gentlemen in private, as opposed to the grandstanding and hostility that tends to be on display. This gives us greater power sharing.

Politicians should go out of office but not out of power. [1] All lawmakers should have a continuous engagement with the legislative process, and perform the oversight role of the legislature, whether in or out of power. This helps create a repeated game and an environment of reciprocity. This takes the system closer to a cooperative equilibrium.

What goes into the law

Public choice theory helps us to think about the drafting of law. In the framework of liberal democracy, we normally think that parliamentary authorization is required, through law, for all coercion of free persons by the state. Hence, our traditional concept has been that the text of the law